

ENGLISH **LIVE**

29

COMPREHENSION & VOCABULARY

UPSC / BANK PO / SSC / OTHERS

SESSION - 29

7th MARCH, 2017

Yesterday once more

A new report compares the global rights scenario today to the 1930s

GARIMELLA SUBRAMANIAM



The opening observation in Amnesty International's latest annual report, that "2016 saw the idea of human dignity and equality, the very notion of a human family, coming under vigorous and relentless assault from powerful narratives of

blame, fear and scapegoating, propagated by those who sought to take or cling on to power almost at any cost", could not have captured in starker terms the current worldwide repudiation of the core ideals enshrined in the 1948 Universal Declaration of Human Rights. The compilation could contribute significantly to alter a general perception about the concerns traditionally championed by the organisation – state repression, torture and extrajudicial executions of guerrilla insurgents in parts of Latin America, Africa and Asia. But the shift in focus points to the more fundamental and universal challenges confronting the post-World War II liberal international order.

The report identifies three most troubling manifestations of the erosion of human rights values. These are the systematic suppression of dissenting voices, a rise in xenophobic and divisive means of political mobilisation and the substitution of an 'us versus them' nationalist narrative for multilateralism. The pervasive and often cross-cutting nature of these influences is self-evident in all the defining economic and political challenges of the day.

THE HINDU

Date: 2nd March, 2017

←
DISCUSSION ON
7th March (Today)

→
DISCUSSION ON
8th March (tomorrow)

RBI, Scrap These Cash Transaction Charges

In February, the government said that 20 million new zero-balance bank accounts had been created, ostensibly to get India's underbanked citizens into the formal financial system. Less than a month later, three of the country's largest private sector banks — ICICI, HDFC and Axis — have imposed costs on consumers for transactions in cash at bank branches. Only four cash withdrawals or deposits would be free per account in a branch. From the fifth transaction, a minimum of ₹150 would be added on as cost. ICICI Bank would levy an additional ₹5 every ₹1,000 transacted. ATM transactions are exempt, they say; only branch transactions are affected. Oh, really?

A country of 1.33 billion people has less than 2.2 lakh ATM machines, mostly confined to metropolitan sites. Everybody else in the vast hinterland has to operate through branch banking. Restricting third-party cash transactions to ₹25,000 per day as HDFC Bank proposes, or ₹50,000 per day, as ICICI Bank will have it, along with these new cash transaction costs, can destroy small and medium business, the informal and farm economy, and slam the brakes on growth.

Zero-balance and salary accounts have not been spared the four-transactions-per-month rule by private banks. If the government and Reserve Bank of India (RBI) do not step in immediately to stop private banks from imposing these transaction costs, state-owned banks might also follow suit. If that happens, then the hope of extending formal banking to most of India will be proved a farce. A new banking apartheid, which favours wealthy customers and large transactions and excludes the small person from the banking system, will become the norm. The aim should be to make digital transactions so easy and costless as to make use of cash look foolish.

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

3rd March, 2017

Yesterday once more

A new report compares the global rights scenario today to the 1930s

GARIMELLA SUBRAMANIAM



GETTY / ISTOCKPHOTO

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THE  **HINDU**

Date: 2nd March, 2017

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- The compilation could contribute significantly to alter a general **perception** about the concerns traditionally championed by the organisation — state **repression**, **torture** and **extrajudicial executions** of **guerrilla insurgents** in parts of Latin America, Africa and Asia.
- But the shift in focus points to the more **fundamental** and **universal** challenges confronting the post-World War II **liberal** international order.
- The report identifies three most troubling **manifestations** of the **erosion** of **human rights** values.
- These are the **systematic suppression** of **dissenting** voices, a rise in **xenophobia** and divisive means of political mobilisation and the substitution of an 'us versus them' nationalist narrative for **multilateralism**.

Yesterday once more

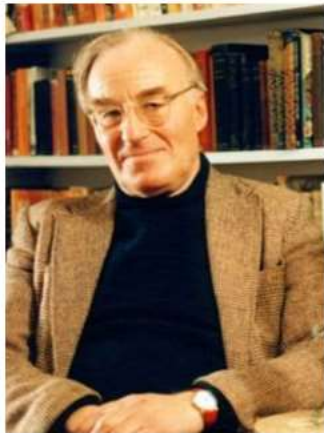
THE  HINDU

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AMNESTY
INTERNATIONAL



Peter Benenson
Founder



Salil Shetty
Secretary General

- It is a Non-Governmental Organization
- It focuses on human rights
- Its objective is to conduct research and prevent abuse of human rights
- Founded in July 1961
- Founder is Peter Benenson
- Headquarters is in London, England, UK
- At present, it has 7 million members
- At present, Salil Shetty is Secretary General of Amnesty International.

Dignity

*Nowadays, it is very
difficult to find persons
with **dignity** and
sincerity.*



Dignity

Calm and control behavior that makes people respect you

Equality

*The ideals of democracy involve economic **equality** and social **equality**.*

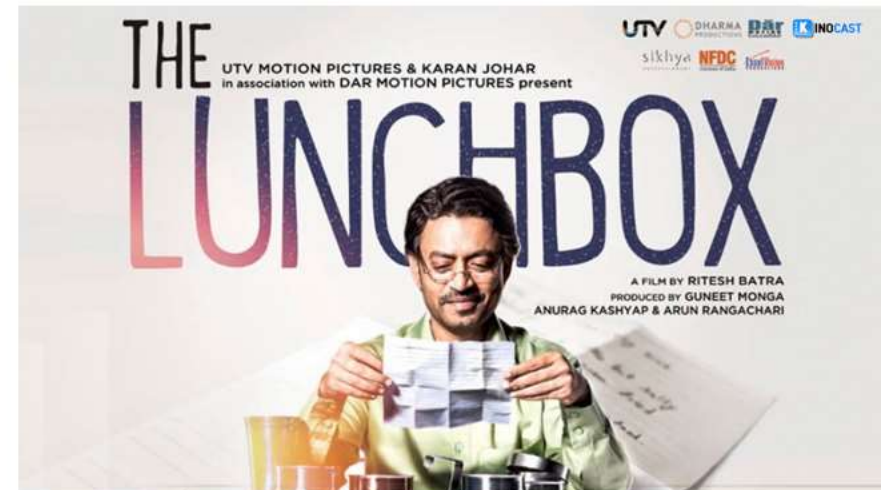


Equality

The right of different groups of people to enjoy similar position and same treatment

Notion

*The success of small budget films in recent times belies the **notion** that only films featuring superstars will be successful.*



Notion

Belief or idea

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Vigorous

*There was **vigorous** opposition across the world to the anti immigration policy of Donald Trump in United States of America.*



Donald Trump
President of the USA

Vigorous

Forceful / energetic / healthy and strong

Relentless

*The policies of Donald Trump have come under **relentless** criticism from various quarters.*



Donald Trump
President of the USA

Relentless

Continuing in a severe or extreme way

Assault



The mob resorted to **assault** on a police officer.



Various public institutions in our country are coming under serious, relentless **assault** from separatist groups.

Assault

Violent attack

Assault

Serious attempt / verbal attack

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Narrative

- No one is alive today to **narrate** the incident of sinking of Titanic in 1912.
- Radha is good at **narrating** crime stories.

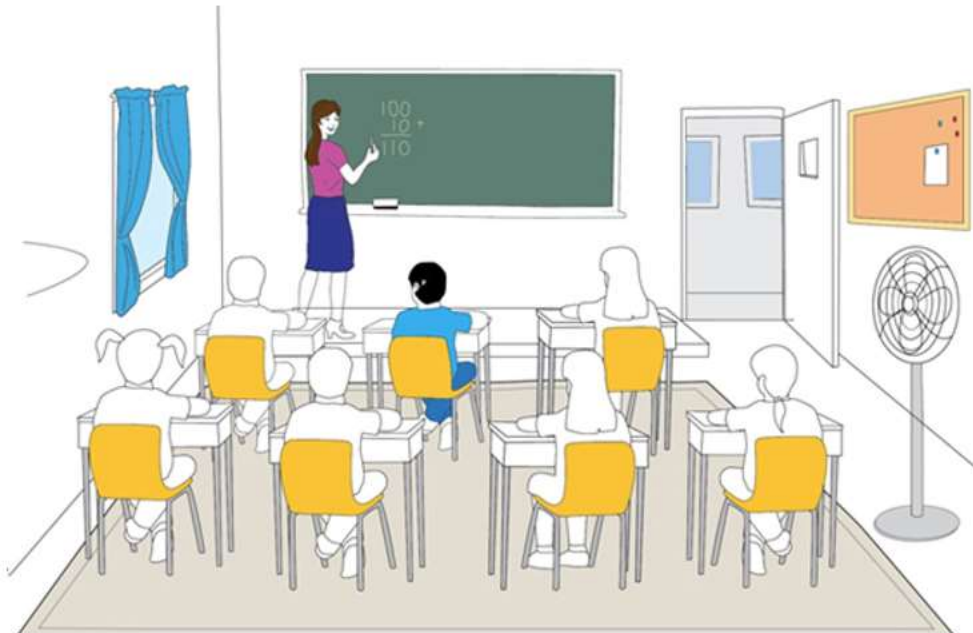


Narrative

Story or description of series of events

Blame

Raju **blames** his teacher for his lack of confidence.



Blame

To think that someone did something wrong or is responsible for something bad happening

Scapegoat

*The reason for the economic problems of several European countries is lavish spending, lack of financial discipline and they made immigrants **scapegoats** for their financial woes.*



Scapegoat

The act of blaming a person or group for something bad that has happened

Propagate



Scientists are discovering new ways to **propagate** plants without seeds.

Propagate



The concept of digital payments is **propagating** quite fast, even in remote parts of the country.

Propagate

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Cling on

*Our politicians will try to **cling on** to power either by hook or by crook.*



Cling on

Trying very hard to keep something

Stark

*The tragedy, which resulted in the death of 7 persons, serves as a **stark** reminder of the dangers of drunk driving.*



Stark

Strong / Rigid

Repudiate

*The changing global order may
repudiate the multilateral
institutions developed
subsequent to the II World War.*



Repudiate

To refuse to accept something as true, good, or reasonable

Repudiate

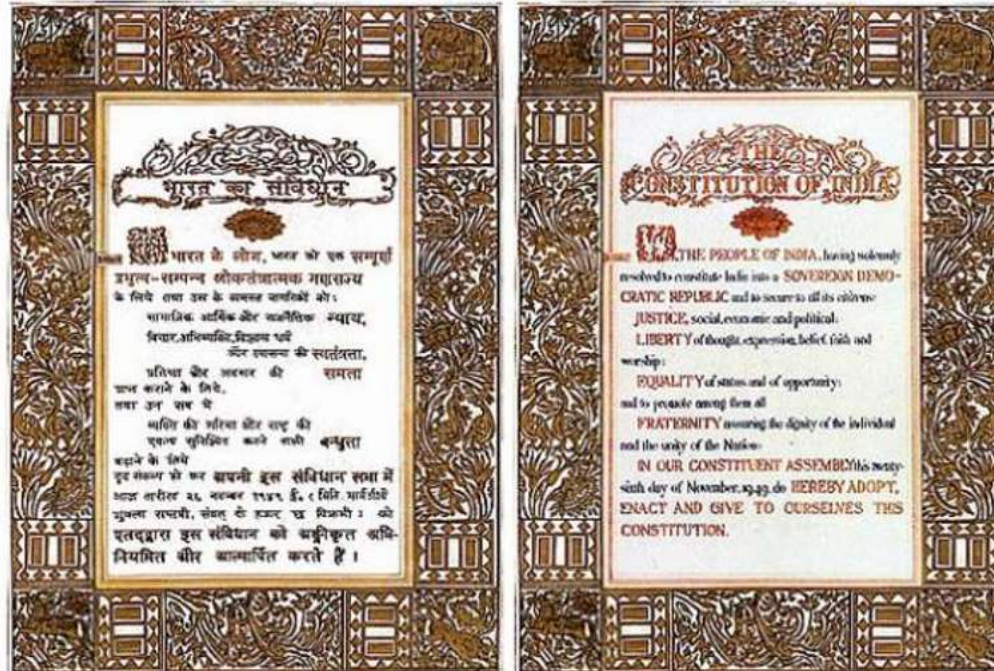
*Despite his claims of innocence, he did very little to **repudiate** the allegations made against him.*



Repudiate

To refuse to accept something as true, good, or reasonable

Enshrined



*Freedom of expression is
enshrined in the Constitution
of India*

Enshrined

Protecting some rights by including in the law / regulations

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The compilation could contribute significantly to alter a general *perception* about the concerns traditionally championed by the organisation — state *repression*, *torture* and *extrajudicial executions* of *guerrilla insurgents* in parts of Latin America, Africa and Asia.

Perception

*The public **perception** about the politicians is not up to the mark in our country*



Perception

A belief or opinion that people think and feel about

Repression

State **repression** is the common feature of dictatorial / authoritarian regimes across the world.



Syria



China



Turkey

Repression

Use of force or violence to control a group of individuals

Torture

***Torture** in police custody is a common feature in our country.*



Torture

Act of causing great physical or mental pain to make someone to do something / to give information

Extrajudicial

***Extrajudicial** killings is the common feature in several countries across the world.*



Extrajudicial

Action which is done without using the official legal system / through a court of law

Execution

Execution of people involved in crimes is quite common in countries like Saudi Arabia & Iran.



Saudi Arabia



Iran

Execution

Killing someone, through legal means

Guerrilla

*Insurgents in North Eastern part of our country have got bases in Myanmar and frequently resort to **guerrilla warfare**.*



Guerrilla

A small independent group taking part in irregular fighting

Insurgency

An active revolt or uprising

Yesterday once more

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But the shift in focus points to the more *fundamental* and *universal* challenges confronting the post-World War II *liberal* international order.

Fundamental

We need to make *fundamental* changes in our education system so as to raise it to the world class.



Fundamental

Forming the base from which everything develops

Universal

*It is not that easy for the governments to get a **universal** approval for their policies.*



Universal

Existing everywhere or involving everyone

Liberal

*Democracy presumes **liberal** thoughts and tolerance for everyone's beliefs.*



Liberal

Respecting and allowing many different types of beliefs or behaviour

Yesterday once more

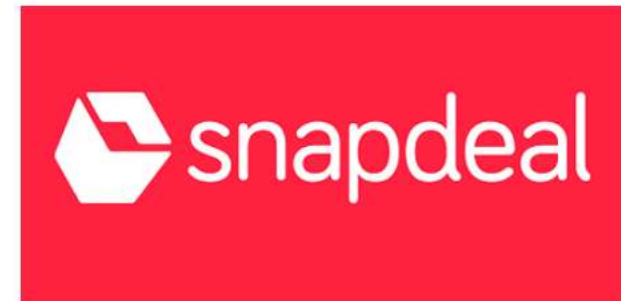
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Manifestation

*Snapdeal decided to lay off 600 employees and it **manifests** underlying problem in e-commerce companies.*



Manifestation

A sign of something existing or happening

Erosion



Erosion

*High NPAs may **erode** the capital base of the public sector banks.*



Erosion

Gradual reduction of something

Human rights

Most of the West Asian countries do not give much importance to **human rights**.



Human rights

The basic rights such as justice and the freedom to live / say the way one wants

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These are the *systematic suppression* of *dissenting* voices, a rise in *xenophobic* and divisive means of political mobilisation and the substitution of an 'us versus them' nationalist narrative for *multilateralism*.

Systematic

*Organizations are expected to manage the affairs in a **systematic** way.*



Systematic

According to an agreed set of methods or organized plan

Suppression

*The peaceful hartal was
suppressed by the brutal
police.*



Suppression

Act of ending something by force

Dissent

***Dissent** should be an
integral part of the
democracy.*



Dissent

A strong difference of opinion on a particular subject

Xenophobia

*After the victory of Donald Trump, **xenophobia** is clearly evident in certain sections of society in the United States of America.*



Donald Trump
President of the USA

Xenophobia

Extreme dislike or fear of foreigners, their customs, their religions, etc.

Multilateralism

Multilateralism is the cornerstone of global world order for the past 3 to 4 decades.



Multilateralism

The situation in which several countries / organizations come together to achieve some desired goal / to deal with a particular problem

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